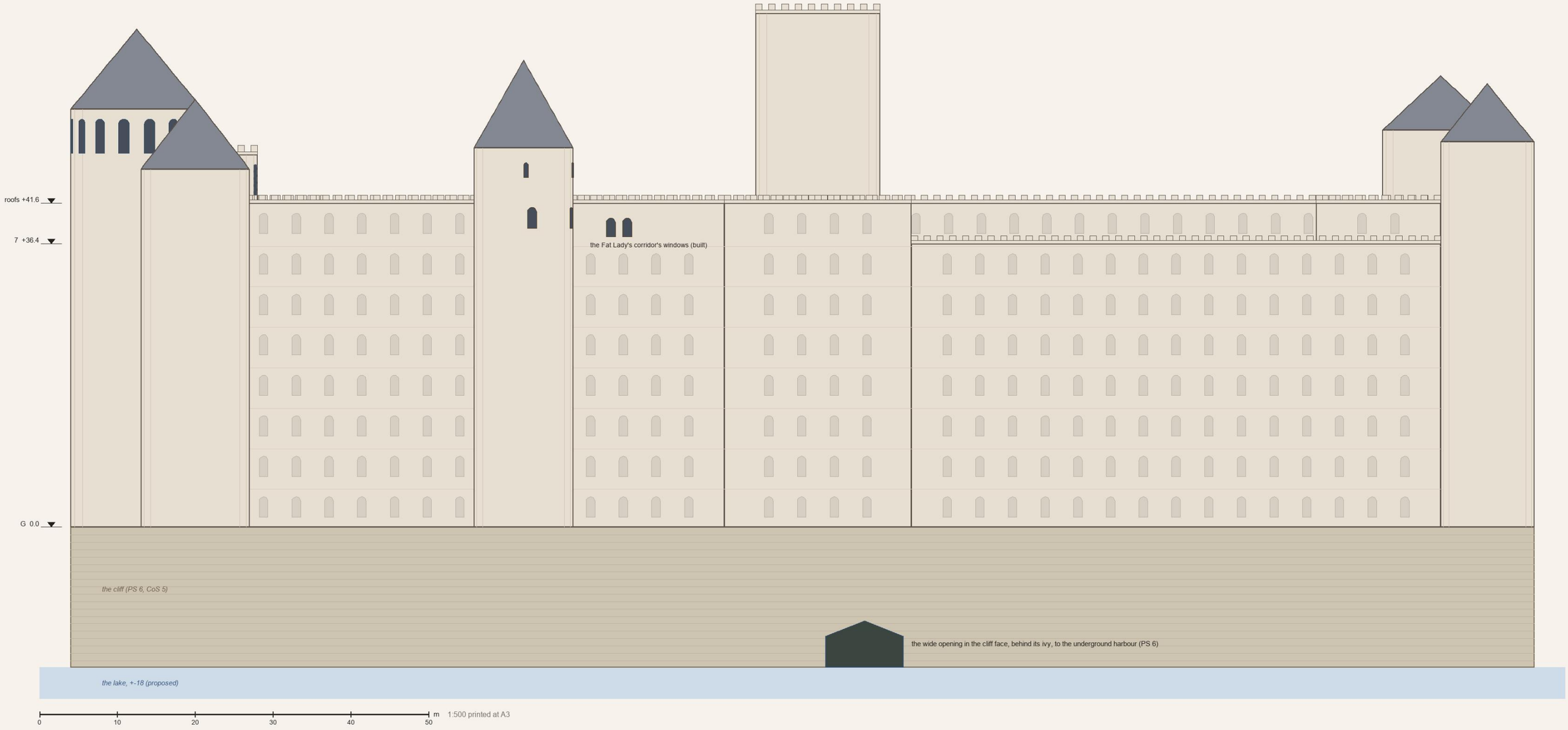
Now: the south elevation as drawn (8.36 pm)

The Architect, 12 October 2026, for Godric. Question 5: the south elevation from the lake, 1:500 at A3, from the castle model (version 5) and the layout of 1930.

The base design of 8.36 pm (architect-sections-2036.pdf, page S): one window rhythm on every storey, one cornice at 41.6, long unbroken ranges; only the towers break the line.



1:500 printed at A3

5.1 Grown over centuries

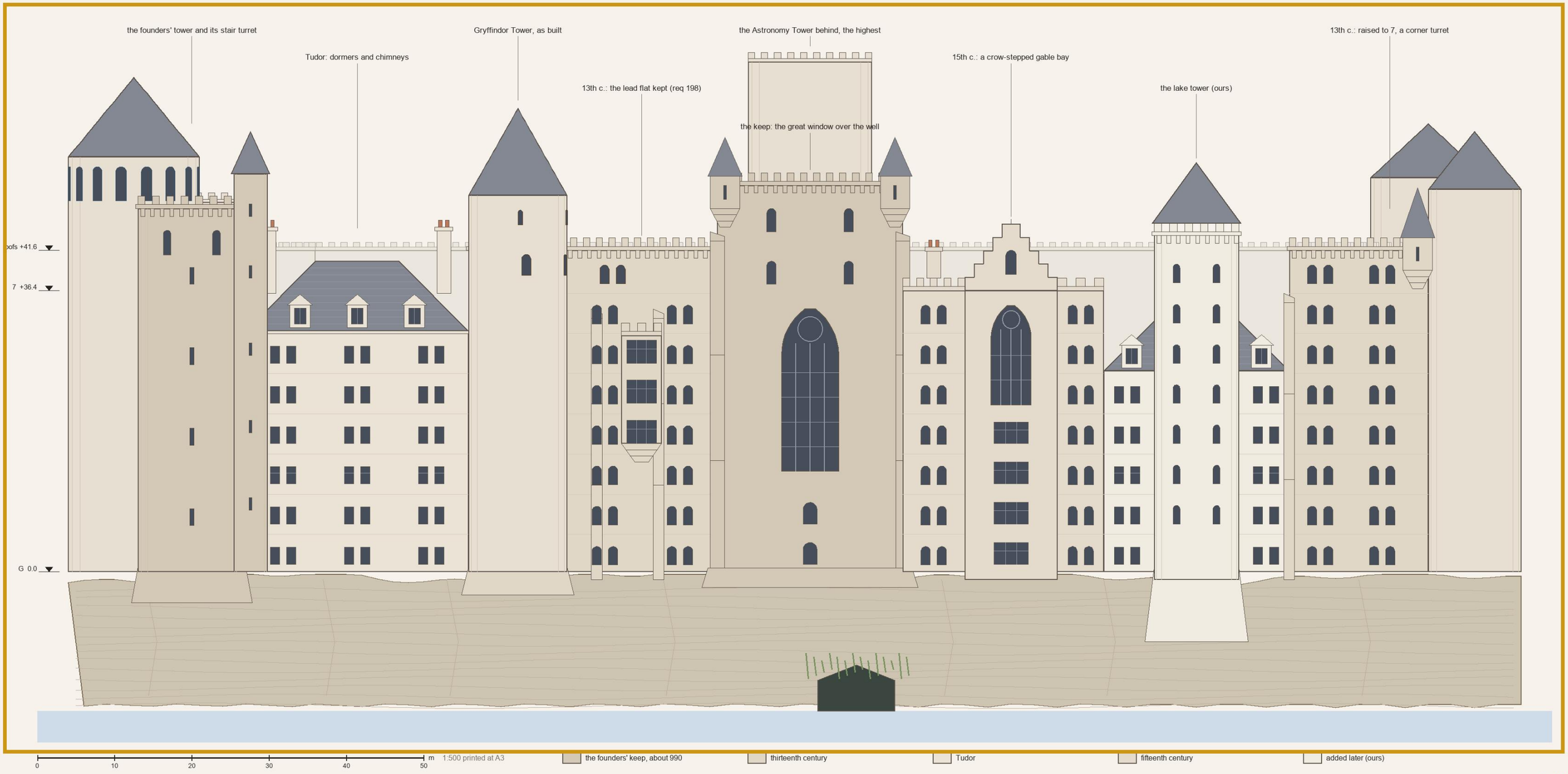
The Architect, 12 October 2026, for Godric. Question 5: the south elevation from the lake, 1:500 at A3, from the castle model (version 5) and the layout of 1930.

The castle built over a thousand years, each age in its own height, roof and window: the founders' keep over the stair hall, raised, with a great window lighting the well of staircases; a thirteenth-century range by Gryffindor Tower with buttresses and an oriel; a Tudor range with dormers and chimneys; a fifteenth-century hall bay under a crow-stepped gable; a lower later link and a lake tower on the cliff's edge. The skyline breaks at every age; the windows follow what stands behind them (corridor lights in pairs, classrooms tall, stairs stepping, stores slits). Precedent: Durham Castle, Norman keep to Tudor ranges on one cliff over the Wear.

In the layout: the Tudor range loses floor 7 west of Gryffindor Tower (2 fill rooms: A study room, Staff bedroom) and puts floor 6 in its roof; the later link loses floor 6 (2: Staff bedroom, A disused classroom) and puts 5 in its roof; the east end gains a floor 7 (18 by 18 m) and the lake tower a room a floor. Every named place stays.

Canon, checked at the gate: "a vast castle with many turrets and towers", its windows sparkling (PS 6); "on the cliff over the lake" (CoS 5); "the many turrets and towers" drawing nearer (PoA 5); "a towering mass of turrets" (OotP 11). The books give no ages, styles or roofs: those are ours, the films where the books are silent.

Held in every study: Gryffindor Tower and its built windows, the corridor's built windows on 7; the lead flat east of the tower at 41.6 (the dormitory's W1 and W2 look over it, req 198); the Astronomy Tower the highest (HBP 27), nothing new above Gryffindor's 60 (the three highest, DH 31).



recommended

5.2 Rooted in the rock

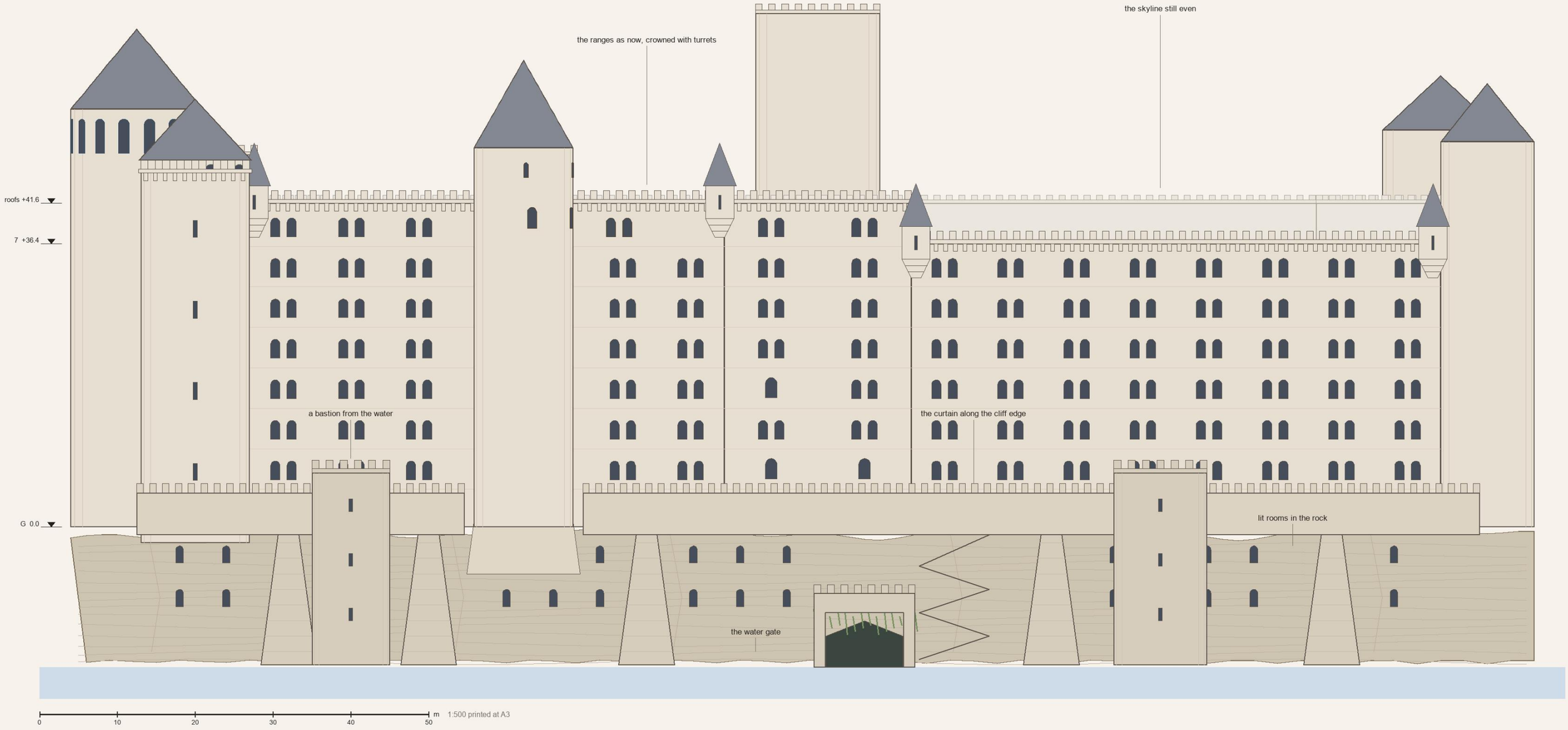
The Architect, 12 October 2026, for Godric. Question 5: the south elevation from the lake, 1:500 at A3, from the castle model (version 5) and the layout of 1930.

The castle carried down the cliff to the water: great spurs buttress the rock, a curtain wall walks the cliff's edge, two round bastions rise from the lake, the harbour gets a water gate and a stair up the face, and lit rooms look out of the rock below the ground floor. Above the curtain the ranges stand much as now, crowned with corner turrets: the drama is 60 m of wall and rock from the boats, but the skyline stays even. Precedent: Mont-Saint-Michel's walls climbing its rock; Edinburgh Castle on its crag.

In the layout: nothing above the ground floor moves; the cliff gains two levels of rooms (new, ours) and the curtain a walk; the boats still come in under the ivy (PS 6).

Canon, checked at the gate: "a vast castle with many turrets and towers", its windows sparkling (PS 6); "on the cliff over the lake" (CoS 5); "the many turrets and towers" drawing nearer (PoA 5); "a towering mass of turrets" (OotP 11). The books give no ages, styles or roofs: those are ours, the films where the books are silent.

Held in every study: Gryffindor Tower and its built windows, the corridor's built windows on 7; the lead flat east of the tower at 41.6 (the dormitory's W1 and W2 look over it, req 198); the Astronomy Tower the highest (HBP 27), nothing new above Gryffindor's 60 (the three highest, DH 31).



5.3 One Gothic build

The Architect, 12 October 2026, for Godric. Question 5: the south elevation from the lake, 1:500 at A3, from the castle model (version 5) and the layout of 1930.

The whole face in one vertical order, as the films draw it where the books are silent: a buttress at every bay rising to a pinnacle, windows paired in pointed frames two storeys tall, steep slate roofs behind the parapets, needle turrets, and a gabled front with a rose window over the stair hall. Rich, but it reads as one build, like a cathedral, not a castle that grew. Precedent: the films' castle; the Palace of Westminster's river front.

In the layout: nothing moves inside; the steep roofs give an attic floor everywhere except east of Gryffindor Tower, where the lead flat stays for the dormitory's views.

Canon, checked at the gate: "a vast castle with many turrets and towers", its windows sparkling (PS 6); "on the cliff over the lake" (CoS 5); "the many turrets and towers" drawing nearer (PoA 5); "a towering mass of turrets" (OotP 11). The books give no ages, styles or roofs: those are ours, the films where the books are silent.

Held in every study: Gryffindor Tower and its built windows, the corridor's built windows on 7; the lead flat east of the tower at 41.6 (the dormitory's W1 and W2 look over it, req 198); the Astronomy Tower the highest (HBP 27), nothing new above Gryffindor's 60 (the three highest, DH 31).

